



考研阅读 逐篇精讲

第二轮：2004 - 2026

2004text2

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考研英语真题 2004年text2 (题干部分)

26. What does the author intend to illustrate with AAA A cars and Zodiac cars?
打算; 想要... 阐明表明
27. What can we infer from the first three paragraphs?
推断出
28. The 4th paragraph suggests that _____.
表明; 暗示; 建议
29. What does the author mean by [“most people are literally having a ZZZ” (Line 2, Paragraph 5)]?
30. Which of the following is true according to the text?

反复 + 倾向

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考研英语真题 2004年text2第1段

Over the past century, all kinds of unfairness and discrimination have been condemned or made illegal. But one insidious form continues to thrive: alphabetism. This, for those as yet unaware of such a disadvantage, refers to discrimination against those whose surnames begin with a letter in the lower half of the alphabet.

of the alphabet.]

注意重点位置冒号后内容

boost v. 推动; 增加

-ism 主义; 学说

ideal n. 理想

idealism n. 理想主义

偏见; 歧视

discrimination = prejudice = bias + against 对... 歧视

繁荣: thrive = flourish = boom = prosper

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考研英语真题 2004年text2第2段

众所周知；长时间以来人们都知道 公司 优势
It has long been known that a taxi firm called AAAA cars has a big advantage
over Zodiac cars / when customers thumb through their phone directories. Less well
known is the advantage that Adam Abbott has in life over Zoë Zysman. English
names are fairly evenly spread between the halves of the alphabet. Yet a
suspiciously large number of top people have surnames beginning with letters
between A and K.

even { adj. 平均的；均质的；平等的；平等的
adv. 甚至；即使
thumb n. 拇指

suspect v. 怀疑 / 认为
doubt v. 怀疑 / 否定

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考研英语真题 2004年text2第3段

respect v./n. 尊敬; 方面

因此
Thus the American president and vice-president have surnames [starting with B and C 分别地各自地]; and 26 of George Bush's predecessors (including his father) 副总统 had surnames in the 前半部分 first half of the alphabet 前辈 against just 16 in the second half. 后一半
Even more striking, 惊人的, 异常的 six of the 首脑 seven heads of government of the G7 rich countries are alphabetically advantaged (字母表地 有优势的 Berlusconi, Blair, Bush, Chirac, Chrétien and Koizumi). The world's three top central bankers (Greenspan, Duisenberg and Hayami) are all close to the top of the alphabet, 即使; 即使 even if one of them really uses 字母 Japanese characters. As are the world's five richest men (Gates, Buffett, Allen, Ellison and Albrecht).

strike v./n. 打击; 罢工; 突然想到; 发现

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考研英语真题 2004年text2第4段

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Can this merely be coincidence? One theory, dreamt up in all the spare time enjoyed by the alphabetically disadvantaged, is that the rot sets in early. At the start of the first year in infant school, teachers seat pupils alphabetically from the front, to make it easier to remember their names. So short-sighted Zysman junior gets stuck in the back row, and is rarely asked the improving questions posed by those insensitive teachers. At the time the alphabetically disadvantaged may think they have had a lucky escape. Yet the result may be worse qualifications, because they get less individual attention, as well as less confidence in speaking publicly.

仅仅 巧合;同时发生
腐烂 开始
排队 学生
记住
近似的
年幼的
卡住;用在...
排
罕见地
不敏感的
幸运的 勉强;摆脱
个人 关注
infant n. 婴幼儿;初期
ad. 婴幼儿的;初期的

row n. 排;争吵 v. 争吵;划
in a row 连续

考研英语真题 2004年text2第5段

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The humiliation continues. At university graduation ceremonies, the ABCs proudly get their awards first; by the time they reach the Zysmans most people are literally having a ZZZ. Shortlists for job interviews, election ballot papers, lists of conference speakers and attendees: all tend to be drawn up alphabetically, and their recipients lose interest as they plough through them.

literally adv. 字面地; 确实
literal adj. 字面的; 逐字的

letter n. 信; 文字

award n. 奖; 奖金; 授予 v. 授予; 颁发
reward n. 回报; 奖励

考研英语真题 2004年text2第1题

关注进群领取笔记及考研真题

Over the past century, all kinds of unfairness and discrimination have been condemned or made illegal. But one insidious form continues to thrive: alphabetism.

This, for those as yet unaware of such a disadvantage, refers to discrimination against those whose surnames begin with a letter in the lower half of the alphabet.

It has long been known that a taxi firm called AAAA cars has a big advantage over Zodiac cars when customers thumb through their phone directories. Less well known is the advantage that Adam Abbott has in life over Zoë Zysman. English names are fairly evenly spread between the halves of the alphabet. Yet a suspiciously large number of top people have surnames beginning with letters between A and K.

26. What does the author intend to illustrate with AAAA cars and Zodiac cars?

[A] A kind of overlooked inequality.

[B] A type of conspicuous bias.

[C] A type of personal prejudice.

[D] A kind of brand discrimination.

考研英语真题 2004年text2第2题

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③ Thus the American president and vice-president have surnames starting with B and C respectively; and 26 of George Bush's predecessors (including his father) had surnames in the first half of the alphabet against just 16 in the second half. Even more striking, six of the seven heads of government of the G7 rich countries are alphabetically advantaged (Berlusconi, Blair, Bush, Chirac, Chrétien and Koizumi). The world's three top central bankers (Greenspan, Duisenberg and Hayami) are all close to the top of the alphabet, even if one of them really uses Japanese characters. As are the world's five richest men (Gates, Buffett, Allen, Ellison and Albrecht).

27. What can we infer from the first three paragraphs?

- [A] In both East and West, names are essential to success. *必要的*
- [B] The alphabet is to blame for the failure of Zoë Zysman. *字母表 对...负有责任 失败*
- [C] Customers often pay a lot of attention to companies' names. *非常关注*
- [D] Some form of discrimination is too subtle to recognize. *识别*

subtle adj.
细微的;微妙的
too...to...
太...以至于不能

考研英语真题 2004年text2第3题

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Can this merely be coincidence? One theory, dreamt up in all the spare time enjoyed by the alphabetically disadvantaged, is that the rot sets in early. At the start of the first year in infant school, teachers seat pupils alphabetically from the front, to make it easier to remember their names. So short-sighted Zysman junior gets stuck in the back row, and is rarely asked the improving questions posed by those insensitive teachers. At the time the alphabetically disadvantaged may think they have had a lucky escape. Yet the result may be worse qualifications, because they get less individual attention, as well as less confidence in speaking publicly.

28. The 4th paragraph suggests that _____
- ☒ [A] questions are often put to the more intelligent students
 - ☒ [B] alphabetically disadvantaged students often escape from class
 - ☒ [C] teachers should pay attention to all of their students
 - ☒ [D] students should be seated according to their eyesight

原文: 教师随时
所有学生同等
关注

考研英语真题 2004年text2第4题

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The humiliation continues. At university graduation ceremonies, the ABCs proudly get their awards first; by the time they reach the Zysmans most people are literally having a ZZZ. Shortlists for job interviews, election ballot papers, lists of conference speakers and attendees: all tend to be drawn up alphabetically, and their recipients lose interest as they plough through them.

29. What does the author mean by “most people are literally having a ZZZ” (Line 2, Paragraph 5)?

[A] They are getting impatient.

[B] They are noisily dozing off.

[C] They are feeling humiliated.

[D] They are busy with word puzzles

zzz....



无聊至极

吵闹地/咕嘟咕嘟

打盹

羞辱

字谜

考研英语真题 2004年text2第5题

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30. Which of the following is true according to the text?

- ~~[A]~~ People with surnames beginning (with N to Z) are often ~~ill-treated~~. 姓 虐待
- ~~[B]~~ VIPs in the Western world gain a great deal from alphabetism. 获得 大量的 字母主义
- ~~[C]~~ The campaign to eliminate alphabetism still has a long way to go. 运动 消除
- ~~[D]~~ Putting things alphabetically may lead to unintentional bias. 非刻意地 偏见 导致

考研英语真题 2004年text2词汇总结

(1) condemn v. 谴责; 证明...有罪

(2) discrimination n. 偏见; 歧视; 区别对待

(3) as yet 到目前为止

(4) thumb through 快速翻阅

(5) directory n. 通讯录; 目录

(6) evenly adv. 平均地; 均等地

(7) suspiciously adv. 怀疑地

suspect v. 怀疑; 以为 n. 嫌疑人

suspicious adj. 怀疑的; 令人怀疑的

偏见 = prejudice = bias
= discrimination + against

thumb n. 拇指

even { adv. 平均的; 平均的; 平均的
adv. 甚至; 即使

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考研英语真题 2004年text2 词汇总结

(8) respectively *adv.* 分别地

respective *adj.* 各自的; 分别的
respect *n./v.* 尊敬

(9) predecessor *n.* 前辈

ancestor = *forefather* 祖先

(10) striking *adj.* 惊人的; 异常的

strike *n./v.* 罢工; 打击; 突然袭击
发现

(11) character *n.* 性格; 品质; 人物; 文字 *v.* 刻写

(12) coincidence *n.* 巧合; 一致

(13) dream up *v.* 凭空想出; 设计出

(14) rot *v.* 腐烂; 逐渐衰弱
n. 腐烂

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考研英语真题 2004年text2词汇总结

(15) infant *n.* 初期; 婴幼儿时期 *adj.* 初期的; 婴幼儿时期的

(16) humiliation *n.* 耻辱 *humiliate v.* 羞辱

(17) literally *adv.* 逐字地; 确实

(18) shortlist *n.* 最终候选名单

(19) plough through *坚持做; 努力做*

(20) be to blame for *对... 负有责任*

(21) subtle *adj.* 微妙的; 不易察觉的

(22) doze off *打盹*

plough v. 耕犁; 破浪/奋力前进

ABCD

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